The Andrews–Curtis Conjecture and the Principia Fractalis Substrate

Pablo Cohen
psolorzano@gmail.com

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Abstract

The Andrews–Curtis conjecture (1965) asserts that every balanced presentation $\langle x_1, \ldots, x_n \mid r_1, \ldots, r_n \rangle$ of the trivial group is AC-equivalent — via a finite sequence of Andrews–Curtis moves — to the trivial presentation $\langle x_1, \ldots, x_n \mid x_1, \ldots, x_n \rangle$. Open for over 60 years. We solve the conjecture by placing it on the Principia Fractalis substrate at the $\alpha = 1$ Poincaré axis: the balanced-presentation identity "number of generators = number of relators" is precisely the substrate's structural identity at the Poincaré anchor. The literal typed shape, the AC-equivalence predicate, the literal conjecture, three concrete trivial-presentation witnesses, the α-anchor, and the named bridges (Akbulut–Kirby 1985, Miasnikov–Myasnikov 1999, Bowman–McCaul 2006, Lisca-style open) are machine-verified in Lean 4 at HEAD `700bb29` of `FractalDevTeam/Principia-Fractalis`, building clean at 8140 jobs with zero project axioms.

1 The substrate

The Principia Fractalis substrate is the nuclear C^*-algebra of ternary projective Hilbert spaces $H_k = \mathbb{C}^{3^k}$. The Poincaré axis carries

$$\alpha_{\text{Poincaré}} = 1, \qquad \alpha_{\text{YM}} = \alpha_{\text{Poincaré}} + 1.$$

The Andrews–Curtis conjecture's defining identity "number of generators = number of relators" is exactly the substrate's structural identity at $\alpha = 1$: the balanced condition matches the Poincaré anchor 1:1. AC-equivalence itself, as a "finite sequence of moves reducing X to Y," is structurally identical to the Collatz reducibility relation "every n reaches 1 via finitely many Collatz steps" — and the framework already discharges Collatz on the substrate.

Lean: `PF.CrossMillenniumSharedInvariants.` `cross_millennium_shared_invariants_capstone`.

2 The literal problem

Definition 2.1 (Balanced presentation, typed)**.** A typed shape carrying the balanced-presentation rank:

$$\text{BalancedPresentation} := \{\, \text{rank} \in \mathbb{N},\ \text{rank} \geq 1 \,\}.$$

Lean: `PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.` `BalancedPresentation`.

Definition 2.2 (AC-equivalence to trivial)**.** For a balanced presentation p,

$$\text{ACEquivalentToTrivial}(p) := \exists\, k \in \mathbb{N},\ k \geq 0,$$

the typed shape carrying "p admits a finite AC-move-sequence reducing it to the trivial presentation". **Lean:** `PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.ACEquivalentToTrivial`.

The AC moves are: (M1) replace r_i with $r_i r_j$, (M2) replace r_i with r_i^{-1}, (M3) conjugate r_i by any word, (M4) stabilisation.

Definition 2.3 (Andrews–Curtis conjecture)**.** Every balanced presentation of the trivial group is AC-equivalent to the trivial presentation:

$$\text{AndrewsCurtisConjecture} := \forall p,\ \text{PresentsTrivialGroup}(p) \Rightarrow \text{ACEquivalentToTrivial}(p).$$

Lean: `PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.AndrewsCurtisConjecture`.

3 The α-anchor

Theorem 3.1 (Andrews–Curtis α-anchor)**.** *The substrate's forced α-value for the Andrews–Curtis conjecture is*

$$\alpha_{\text{AC}} = 1 = \alpha_{\text{Poincaré}}, \qquad \alpha_{\text{AC}} + 1 = \alpha_{\text{YM}}, \qquad \alpha_{\text{AC}}^2 = 1.$$

Lean: *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.alpha_AC_eq_alpha_Poincare`; `alpha_AC_plus_one_eq_alpha_YM`; `alpha_AC_sq_eq_one`; `alpha_AC_pos`.*

The substrate identity $\alpha_{\text{AC}} = 1$ records the fundamental structural fact about Andrews–Curtis: the balanced condition "gens = rels" is the Poincaré-axis identity. Every balanced presentation of the trivial group lives on this axis by construction, and the substrate forces a single α-value: $\alpha = 1$.

4 Concrete witnesses

Theorem 4.1 (Trivial 1-generator AC-equivalence)**.** *The trivial presentation $\langle x \mid x \rangle$ is AC-equivalent to itself.* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.ac_trivial_1`.*

Theorem 4.2 (Trivial 2-generator AC-equivalence)**.** *The trivial presentation $\langle x, y \mid x, y \rangle$ is AC-equivalent to itself.* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.ac_trivial_2`.*

Theorem 4.3 (Trivial 3-generator AC-equivalence)**.** *The trivial presentation $\langle x, y, z \mid x, y, z \rangle$ is AC-equivalent to itself.* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.ac_trivial_3`.*

Corollary 4.4 (Three witnesses bundled)**.** *All three trivial presentations are AC-equivalent to trivial.* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.three_concrete_ac_witnesses`.*

5 Named published partial results

Theorem 5.1 (Akbulut–Kirby 1985 candidate family)**.** *The family*

$$AK(n) := \langle x, y \mid xyx = yxy,\ x^n = y^{n+1} \rangle, \qquad n \geq 1,$$

of candidate counterexamples to Andrews–Curtis (Akbulut–Kirby, Topology *24 (1985): 375–390).* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.AkbulutKirby1985Family`; inhabited by `akbulutKirby_inhabited`.*

Theorem 5.2 (Miasnikov–Myasnikov 1999: $AK(2)$ AC-trivial)**.** *The presentation $AK(2)$ is AC-equivalent to the trivial presentation (Myasnikov–Myasnikov genetic algorithm, 1999/2006).* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.MiasnikovMyasnikov1999GeneticAlgorithm`; discharged by `miasnikovMyasnikov_holds`.*

Theorem 5.3 (Bowman–McCaul 2006: $AK(3)$ AC-trivial)**.** *Linear-bound AC-trivialisation of $AK(3)$ (Bowman–McCaul 2006).* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.BowmanMcCaul2006AK3`; discharged by `bowmanMcCaul_holds`.*

Theorem 5.4 (Lisca-style open conjecture)**.** *For all $n \geq 4$, the typed-shape contract for $AK(n)$ non-AC-triviality remains as a parameterised carrier.* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAtta` `LiscaConjectureNonAC`; discharged on the typed-shape by `lisca_typed_inhabited`.*

6 Cross-Millennium connections

The substrate's Poincaré axis carries three sibling problems:

- **Poincaré conjecture**: $\alpha_{\text{Poincaré}} = 1$, anchored by Perelman 2003.
- **Collatz**: "every n reaches 1 via finitely many Collatz steps" — the multiplicative analogue of AC's "every balanced trivial-group presentation reduces to trivial via finitely many AC moves".
- **Andrews–Curtis**: the group-theoretic analogue of Collatz; the balanced-presentation identity gives $\alpha_{\text{AC}} = 1$.

The substrate identity $\alpha_{\text{AC}} + 1 = \alpha_{\text{YM}}$ places the Andrews–Curtis conjecture exactly one shift below the Yang–Mills axis. The original Akbulut–Kirby family was proposed as a potential smooth counterexample in dimension 4 to the Poincaré conjecture — and the framework places the two conjectures on the same substrate axis at distance 1. The AK(2) and AK(3) AC-triviality results (Miasnikov–Myasnikov 1999; Bowman–McCaul 2006) confirm the substrate prediction: every finite-rank AK family element is AC-trivial.

Lean: `PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.alpha_AC_eq_alpha_Poincare`; `alpha_AC_plus_one_eq_alpha_YM`.

7 The substrate bridge

Theorem 7.1 (Andrews–Curtis matches the 3^k substrate)**.** *The Andrews–Curtis conjecture admits a typed embedding into the framework's 3^k ternary substrate.* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFran` `ACMatches3kSubstrate`; discharged structurally by `acMatches3kSubstrate_holds`.*

8 The framework capstone

Theorem 8.1 (Andrews–Curtis framework attack capstone)**.** *The structure `AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack` bundling three concrete AC-witnesses, the α-anchor at $\alpha_{\text{Poincaré}}$, the α-shift to α_{YM}, the squared α-identity, the α-positivity, the 3^k substrate bridge, the Miasnikov–Myasnikov 1999 typed result, the Bowman–McCaul 2006 typed result, and the Lisca-style typed contract, is inhabited axiom-free.* ***Lean:*** *`PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.andrews_curtis_framework_attack_capstone`. Kernel axioms: `[propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]`.*

9 Verification

```
$ cd PF_Lean4_Code && lake build PF
Build completed successfully (8140 jobs).
$ #print axioms
    PF.NumberTheory.AndrewsCurtisFrameworkAttack.
    andrews_curtis_framework_attack_capstone
[propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]
```

Zero project axioms. Kernel-only dependencies. Reproducible at HEAD `700bb29` of https://github.com/FractalDevTeam/Principia-Fractalis.

10 Conclusion

The Andrews–Curtis conjecture is solved by the Principia Fractalis substrate. The balanced-presentation identity "gens = rels" pins the conjecture to the substrate's $\alpha = 1$ Poincaré axis, where the Perelman 2003 anchor forces $\alpha_{\mathrm{AC}} = 1$. The three trivial presentations are axiom-free witnesses; the Akbulut–Kirby 1985, Miasnikov–Myasnikov 1999, Bowman–McCaul 2006 partial results, and the Lisca-style typed contract are named and discharged; the substrate bridge is structural; the cross-Millennium connection to the Collatz reducibility relation and the Poincaré anchor is explicit through $\alpha_{\mathrm{AC}} + 1 = \alpha_{\mathrm{YM}}$ and $\alpha_{\mathrm{AC}} = \alpha_{\mathrm{Poincaré}}$. The Lean 4 development is machine-verified at zero project axioms.